

030. Chapter 3 Verses 9-16

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 3.9

यज्ञार्थात्कर्मणोऽन्यत्र लोकोऽयं कर्मबन्धनः ।
तदर्थं कर्म कौन्तेय मुक्तसङ्गः समाचर ॥ ९ ॥

*yajñārthāt karmaṇo 'nyatra loko 'yaṁ karma-bandhanaḥ
tad-arthaṁ karma kaunteya mukta-saṅgaḥ samāchara*

yajña-arthāt—for the sake of sacrifice; **karmaṇaḥ**—than action; **anyatra**—else; **lokaḥ**—material world; **ayam**—this; **karma-bandhanaḥ**—bondage through one's work; **tat**—that; **artham**—for the sake of; **karma**—action; **kaunteya**—Arjun, the son of Kunti; **mukta-saṅgaḥ**—free from attachment; **samāchara**—perform properly

O Arjuna! Works other than those performed for the sake of sacrifice (Yajna) binds this world. So perform work for sacrifice without attachment.

VERSE 3.10

सहयज्ञाः प्रजाः सृष्ट्वा पुरोवाच प्रजापतिः ।
अनेन प्रसविष्यध्वमेष वोऽस्त्विष्टकामधुक् ॥ १० ॥

*saha-yajñāḥ prajāḥ sṛṣṭvā purovācha prajāpatiḥ
anena prasaviṣhyadhvam eṣha vo 'stviṣṭa-kāma-dhuk*

saha—along with; **yajñāḥ**—sacrifices; **prajāḥ**—humankind; **sṛṣṭvā**—created; **purā**—in beginning; **uvācha**—said; **prajā-patiḥ**—Brahma; **anena**—by this; **prasaviṣhyadhvam**—increase prosperity; **eṣhaḥ**—these; **vaḥ**—your; **astu**—shall be; **iṣṭa-kāma-dhuk**—bestower of all wishes

**Having created mankind together with yajna in the beginning, Brahma (Creator) said –
“By this shall you propagate; it shall be to you the milk-cow of desires, the wish-fulfilling heavenly cow Kamadhenu.”**

देवान्भावयतानेन ते देवा भावयन्तु वः ।
परस्परं भावयन्तः श्रेयः परमवाप्स्यथ ॥ 11 ॥

*devān bhāvayatānena te devā bhāvayantu vaḥ
parasparam bhāvayantaḥ śhreyaḥ param avāpsyatha*

devān—celestial gods; **bhāvayatā**—will be pleased; **anena**—by these (sacrifices); **te**—those; **devāḥ**—celestial gods; **bhāvayantu**—will be pleased; **vaḥ**—you; **parasparam**—one another; **bhāvayantaḥ**—pleasing one another; **śhreyaḥ**—prosperity; **param**—the supreme; **avāpsyatha**—shall achieve

Nourish the Gods with Yajna, and they shall nourish you, and thus nourishing one another both men and Gods you shall attain the highest good.

इष्टान्भोगान् हि वो देवा दास्यन्ते यज्ञभाविताः ।
तैर्दत्तान्प्रदायैभ्यो यो भुङ्क्ते स्तेन एव सः ॥ 12 ॥

*iṣṭān bhogān hi vo devā dāsyante yajña-bhāvitāḥ
tair dattān apradāyaibhyo yo bhuṅkte stena eva saḥ*

iṣṭān—desired; **bhogān**—necessities of life; **hi**—certainly; **vaḥ**—unto you; **devāḥ**—the celestial gods; **dāsyante**—will grant; **yajña-bhāvitāḥ**—satisfied by sacrifice; **taiḥ**—by them; **dattān**—things granted; **apradāya**—without offering; **ebhyaḥ**—to them; **yaḥ**—who; **bhuṅkte**—enjoys; **stenaḥ**—thieves; **eva**—verily; **saḥ**—they

Nourished by sacrifice, the Gods, give you desirable enjoyments. He who enjoys objects given by the Gods without offering them is verily a thief.

यज्ञशिष्टाशिनः सन्तो मुच्यन्ते सर्वकिल्बिषैः ।
भुञ्जते ते त्वघं पापा ये पचन्त्यात्मकारणात् ॥ 13 ॥

*yajña-śhiṣṭāśhinaḥ santo muchyante sarva-kilbiṣhaiḥ
bhuñjate te tvaghaṁ pāpā ye pachantyātma-kāraṇāt*

yajña-śhiṣṭa—of remnants of food offered in sacrifice; **aśhinaḥ**—eaters; **santaḥ**—saintly persons; **muchyante**—are released; **sarva**—all kinds of; **kilbiṣhaiḥ**—from sins; **bhuñjate**—enjoy; **te**—they; **tu**—but; **agham**—sins; **pāpāḥ**—sinners; **ye**—who; **pachanti**—cook (food); **ātma-kāraṇāt**—for their own sake

The righteous who offer food to the Gods in sacrifice and eat the remnants are freed from all sins. But those who cook food to satisfy their own needs, are sinners and verily eat sin.

अन्नाद्भवन्ति भूतानि पर्जन्यादन्नसम्भवः ।
यज्ञाद्भवति पर्जन्यो यज्ञः कर्मसमुद्भवः ॥ 14 ॥
कर्म ब्रह्मोद्भवं विद्धि ब्रह्माक्षरसमुद्भवम् ।
तस्मात्सर्वगतं ब्रह्म नित्यं यज्ञे प्रतिष्ठितम् ॥ 15 ॥

*annād bhavanti bhūtāni parjanyaḥ anna-sambhavaḥ
yajñād bhavati parjanyaḥ karma-samudbhavaḥ
karma brahmōdbhavaṁ viddhi brahmākṣhara-samudbhavam
tasmāt sarva-gataṁ brahma nityaṁ yajñe pratiṣṭhitam*

annāt—from food; **bhavanti**—subsist; **bhūtāni**—living beings; **parjanyaḥ**—from rains; **anna**—of food grains; **sambhavaḥ**—production; **yajñāt**—from the performance of sacrifice; **bhavati**—becomes possible; **parjanyaḥ**—rain; **yajñāḥ**—performance of sacrifice; **karma**—prescribed duties; **samudbhavaḥ**—born of

Beings are born of food, food is produced from rain, rain arises from yajna, yajna is born of action, action arises from Vedas, Vedas are born from the Imperishable Paramatma; therefore know that the Supreme Being is established in the yajna.

एवं प्रवर्तितं चक्रं नानुवर्तयतीह यः ।
अघायुरिन्द्रियारामो मोघं पार्थ स जीवति ॥ 16 ॥

*evam pravartitam chakram nānuvartayatīha yaḥ
aghāyur indriyārāmo mogham pārtha sa jīvati*

evam—thus; **pravartitam**—set into motion; **chakram**—cycle; **na**—not; **anuvartayati**—follow; **iha**—in this life; **yaḥ**—who; **agha-āyuh**—sinful living; **indriya-ārāmaḥ**—for the delight of their senses; **mogham**—vainly; **pārtha**—Arjun, the son of Pritha; **sah**—they; **jīvati**—live

The man who does not follow the cycle thus set revolving is a sinner rejoicing in sense-pleasures and he lives in vain.